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FRAUD PREVENTION

Bank details changed by email?

A step-by-step procedure for the most common way companies lose money: a supplier's account is "updated" in an email that looks right.

Six steps, every time

Use it for every request to change where you pay, even from a supplier you have worked with for years.

01 Do not update from the email

Nothing in the payment system changes on the basis of an email, a PDF or a message alone.

02 Call the number you already have

Use the phone number from your contract or supplier file. Never the number in the email or its signature.

03 Confirm both old and new details

Ask your known contact to confirm the old account and the new one, and the reason for the change.

04 Second approver signs the change

A different person approves the change in the system and records how it was verified.

05 Confirm the first payment

After the first payment to the new account, confirm receipt with the supplier by phone before the next one.

06 Log it

Date, requester, how verified, who approved. Keep the log with the supplier record.

Red flags in the request

- Urgency or secrecy: "pay today", "keep this confidential", "the director is travelling".
- The sender's domain differs by one character or ends differently.
- The new account is in another country, currency or name than the supplier.
- The email arrives just before a large invoice is due.

What to say to the supplier

A short script your team can use on the call-back.

01 **Opening**

"We received a request to change your bank details. Before we update anything, we confirm by phone with every supplier."

02 **Verification**

"Could you confirm the account we paid last time, the new account, and why it changed?"

03 **Close**

"Thank you. A second person on our side will approve the change and we will confirm the first payment with you."

- [ ] Called number on file
- [ ] Second approver signed
- [ ] Log updated
- [ ] Old and new details confirmed
- [ ] First payment confirmed
- [ ] Team informed

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Paying suppliers in several countries?

Tell us your route. We will show you how beneficiaries are added and verified at ArtPay, and what is checked before each payment leaves.

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